TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, MARCH 10, 2021
6:30 PM
AMENDED

1. **Call to order -**

   Mayor Goette called the meeting to order 6:30 pm.

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

   Those that were present: Mayor Beth Goette and Council Members Ed Drohan, Larry Ward, Dave Crenshaw, John Henry, Dana Williams, Brooks Barbarize. Staff in attendance: Interim Town Administrator and Finance Administrator, Molly Sims; Accounts and Utility Clerk, Katina Spaulding; Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow; Clerk of Council, Deatre Denion; Police Chief, Sean Clayton; Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman and Public Works Manager, Oscar Crosby.

3. **Approval of Meeting Agenda -**

   Mayor Goette explained the agenda needed to be amended to remove Municipal Tax Billing and replace with Hotel/Motel/Short-term Resolution. **Council Member Williams made the motion to approve the amended agenda with a second by Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting**:
   Minutes of February 10, 2021

   Mayor Goette asked for a motion to approve the February 10th meeting minutes. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve the minute with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

Consent Agenda:

5. **Hotel/Motel/Short-term Rental Resolution** – removed Municipal Tax Billing and added resolution

6. **Approval of Transfer of Funds from General Fund to ICS**

   Mayor Goette asked for a motion to approve the consent agenda. **Council Member Williams made the motion to approve the consent agenda with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

Discussion Agenda:

7. **Approval of Victory Plumbing, LLC Home Occupation License**

Kyle Hagemes was present and explained how he is only using his home for a home office. Council Member Williams asked about location of trucks and materials. Mr. Hagmes explained it is one truck and all materials are stored in the truck. **Council Member Henry made the motion to approve the home occupation license with a second by Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.**

8. **Approval of New Alcohol License for Desposito's LLC**

The applicant was not in attendance and Mayor Goette had some questions concerning the Desposito's LLC. **Council Member Drohan made a motion to table the application with second by Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.**

9. **Approval of New Alcohol License for R&W Entertainment DBA Tipsy Turtle Tiki Tours**

Tom Wienckoski was present and he explained they wish to provide alcohol on their leisure boat tours. Council Member Barbaree asked what routes they will take. Mr. Wienckoski explained it is an hour or so tour and will be up Turners Creek and go up to Paula Dean's place. Clerk of Council Denion explained they have a 6 pack license which does not require inspections. Both DNR and Coast Guard were contacted about the license. Council Member Henry asked what is a 6 pack license. Mr. Wienckoski explained it is a license allowing no more than 6 passengers and captains certification. Council Member Drohan asked where R&W Entertainment resided. Mr. Wienckoski explained they have the Escape Club downtown. Council Member Drohan was concerned about business license being from another location but Clerk of Council Denion explained they have submitted for a business license as well, but it does not need to come before Council. **Council Member Drohan made the motion to approve with a second by Council Member Williams. The motion passed unanimously.**

10. **Planning and Zoning:**

a) **Petitioner:** Olatunji Awe
Request: Rezoning to R-3 (Multi-family)
Parcel Involved: 3-0292-03-016
Location: Lot 16 Warsaw Pl (Fish Bait Trail)
P & Z approved unanimously

Olatunji Awe was present virtually. It was explained he wishes to rezone from Institutional – Professional to Residential – 3 for multifamily units. Town Attorney Barrow explained all the lots surrounding are residential single and duplexes. Council Member Drohan pointed out it was designed to have condos. Council Member Williams asked about infrastructure. Town Attorney Barrow pointed out that comes during the building process. This is just a rezoning. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion to approve the rezoning with a second from Council Member Drohan. The motion passed unanimously.**

b) **Petitioner:** Village on The Bluff, LLC
Request: Parking Approval
Parcel Involved: 3-0005-06-002
Location: 2919 River Dr.
P & Z approved unanimously

Ansley Williams was in attendance with Laurie DeVegter present virtually. It was explained they wish to utilize another property within 300 feet of the development for up to 15 parking spaces. Council Member Henry asked the likelihood of the development using those 15 parking spaces. Mr. Williams stated he did not anticipate them being used except maybe for visitors. The development is more for a one car per unit for at least seven units. Council Member Crenshaw asked if there were any variance requests. Town Attorney Barrow and Clerk of Council Denion explained the parking requirements require 2.5 per unit. Most of these units will not need 2.5 parking spots. The commercial business has not been decided and parking varies on what type of businesses will use the space. They have planned for worse case scenario. Mayor Goette asked what would happen if someone wished to purchase property where the additional 15 parking slots are on. Town Attorney Barrow explained there will be a legal agreement to allow these parking spots to continue with any purchase. Jill Havens 3001 ½ River Dr came forth and spoke with concerns of parking on their property. She asked to see the parking plan. Clerk of Council Denion explained at this time an actual parking plan was not required. This is only to receive approval to use another property to have up to 15 parking spots. The parking plan will be submitted with the complete building plans for a permit. **Council Member Drohan made the motion to approve with note of 19 parking spots are to be on the actual site. Council Member Crenshaw seconded the motion. The motion passed unanimously.**

c) **Petitioner:** Town of Thunderbolt
Request: Rezoning to Victory Drive District
Parcel Involved: 3-0004-12-021L
Location: 2708 Mechanics Ave
P & Z approved unanimously

Interim Town Administrator explained in order for the Town to lease out the library building to a company for office space the parcel needs to be rezoned. This parcel is adjacent to the Victory Drive District which allows for office space. Mayor Goette asked if it was advertised and was a sign placed on the property. Clerk of Council Denion stated it was advertised and a sign was placed on the parcel. **Council Member Drohan made the motion to approve the zoning change with a second by Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.**

11. **Finance Report**:

a) Municipal Tax Collections in 2021

Tax Years 2011-2019	$ 991.50
Tax Year 2020	$ 33,367.04

b) Municipal Tax Outstanding as of February 28, 2021

Tax Years 2011-2019	$ 25,047.18
Tax Year 2020	$ 35,409.91

Interim Town Administrator Sims stated staff are working towards the audit. Letters were sent out to collect delinquent taxes. Interim Town Administrator Sims stated she expects some delinquent tax parcels will require a lien and a tax sale. Council Member Crenshaw asked when we turn over the taxes will it be retroactive. Interim Town Administrator Sims explained no, anything before 2021 will be the Town's responsibility. Interim Town Administrator Sims went on the explained why the contract for municipal tax collection was pulled. Before the new Tax Commissioner was sworn in all renewal contracts were renewed. When a County collects for municipalities there is a fee per parcel given to Chatham County and the Tax Commissioner. The new Tax Commissioner increased the

Tax Commissioner fee from $1.50 to $3.50. The County fee stayed the same at $2.50. Council Member Crenshaw asked Town Attorney Barrow if this is legal. Town Attorney Barrow explained he finds it unusual but does not know if the Tax Commissioner can raise it on her own. Interim Town Administrator Sims stated she will send out an email with details on the cash shift.

Council Member Crenshaw asked about the library. Interim Town Administrator Sims explained the contract was signed and Bob Fischer, Building Inspector, did an inspection to see what maintenance the Town needs to complete.

12. **Department Report –** Written Reports Submitted

by: Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police
Fire –Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman
Public Works Department – Oscar Crosby, Public Works Manager

13. **Legal Report – Town Attorney**

a) Second Reading Peddlers, Solicitors and Canvassers Ordinance
Barrow explained this is a second reading. There are a few allowed solicitations but a permit is needed. Council Member Crenshaw many times the individuals are not really soliciting but checking for homes that are easy targets to rob. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion to approve with a second by Council Member Ward.** Drohan asked Chief if this will help. **The motion passed unanimously.**

14. **Mayor and Council –**

a) Water & Sewer Committee – Council Member Drohan

Council Member Drohan made the motion in light of the importance of effectively utilizing the time remaining for the current Council relative to the needs of the Town of Thunderbolt regarding the replacement or renewal of the sewer line feeding into the Presidents Street substation that the following steps be taken:

1- **that the ad hoc committee for water and sewer be utilized to communicate with the City of Savannah regarding the importance of these improvements and to consider the most appropriate and cost-efficient solutions. Furthermore, the makeup of this ad hoc committee shall be determined by those members of Council expressing interest in this project.**
2- **that the Town Administrator shall immediately contact the City of Savannah at the highest and most appropriate administrative level in order to establish an initial meeting to discuss the needs of the Town of Thunderbolt relative to these improvements.**
3- **that Oscar Crosby shall participate with the ad hoc committee in pursuit of these improvements and**
4- **that the portion of the budget set aside for consulting with the Town's engineering firm be made available to the ad hoc committee for addressing questions which may arise as a result of these discussions.**

Council Member Crenshaw seconded the motion. In the meeting we have been having over the last 45 days, the initial efforts and the council before still have the big elephant in the room. The sewer line. We have made contact with the City of Savannah but have not moved forward on the cost to the Town. Public Works Manager Crosby explained they had a conference call meeting with the new Director but nothing else since then. **The motion passed unanimously.**

Mayor Goette asked for a motion to adjourn into Executive Session. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion with a second by Council Member Williams. The motion passed unanimously.**

15. **Executive Session-** Mayor requests a motion and a second to recess into executive session for the purpose of Legal and/or Personnel matters.

    Council Member Henry made the motion to move to executive session with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.

    Council Member Ward made the motion to enter into regular meeting with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.

    Council Member Ward made the motion to extent employee relief pay for COVID to April 30th. Council Member Drohan made the second. The motion passed unanimously.

    Council Member Drohan made the motion to adjourn with a second by Council Member Williams. The motion passed unanimously.

16. **Adjournment:**

    The meeting adjourned at 8:01 pm.

Beth E Goette

Mayor, Beth E. Goette

Clerk of Council, Deatre N. Denion